

SKILLS GUIDE



Good writing and presentation skills to communicate with a wide range of people.



Time-management skills to meet deadlines on several projects running at once.



Excellent problem-solving skills for analyzing planning applications from clients.



Knowledge of any new business developments, political initiatives, and environmental issues.



Clear understanding of planning rules and regulations to be able to prepare detailed reports.



CHIEF PLANNING OFFICER

Manages a local or regional planning office and works with other branches of government to prepare the designs necessary to shape a town or region.

Town planners have been around since the world's first towns and cities arose in Mesopotamia around 4500 BCE.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **ARCHITECT** *see pp. 194–195*
- ▶ **COST ENGINEER** *see pp. 198–199*
- ▶ **HISTORIC BUILDINGS INSPECTOR** Ensures that a wide variety of historic buildings are preserved and maintained appropriately. Historic building inspectors usually hold at least a bachelor's degree in a relevant subject.
- ▶ **HOUSING MANAGER** Supports the development of new housing for local authorities and housing associations. Housing managers also work with people living in existing local authority-owned housing programs to ensure that the buildings are maintained properly.

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Urban design • Geography • Environmental studies • Mathematics • Landscape design • Computer-aided Design (CAD)



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS Employers typically look for candidates with a bachelor's degree, a master's degree, and professional accreditation.



LIFESTYLE Work hours are regular, but town planners may have to work overtime to meet clients, view sites, and attend public meetings.



LOCATION Town planners work in an office some of the time, but travel is required to view potential sites and meet with developers and the public.



THE REALITIES Dealing with tight schedules and budgets can be stressful. Town planning decisions may also be unpopular with local people.